

File hamster

There are lots of backup applications available out there. However, at times you don't want a back up but a previous version of a file. File Hamster is not only a backup application, but it also allows you to make retrievable copies of your files as saved versions, on the fly. This version tracking application provides real-time backup and archiving of your files while you work. Sure, you have Shadow Copy bundled with Vista, but this applications does the job much better and is free; besides you can even install it even on XP. The application allows you to monitor specific files on your hard drive and automatically create incremental backups whenever those files are modified. The best part about it is that it lets you make notes for each version about the changes that have been made, allowing you to quickly locate a specific revision or provide a detailed account of the work you've done on a file.

Getting started

One you install the application it will automatically run a wizard that lets you specify the location of the Library where all your revisions to files will be saved. Specify a location and click next. Once you are on the main interface go to **View > Revision List**. This will bring up the revision list pane at the bottom of the screen. So now the interface is divided into the Watch Tree and the Revision List.

Create a Directory watch

Right click your library and select Add Directory watch... This will basically let you specify which folder(s) FileHamster should keep track of. Once you specify the location of the folder it will ask you the manner in which you want to track it. The options include watching for all files or specific file types. If you wish to track only documents, select the 'Watch this type or pattern' radio button and enter *.doc in the text field. On clicking OK, you will have to select which files the application should

make an initial revision copy for. It's best to select all files.

Defining the maximum size and number of older versions

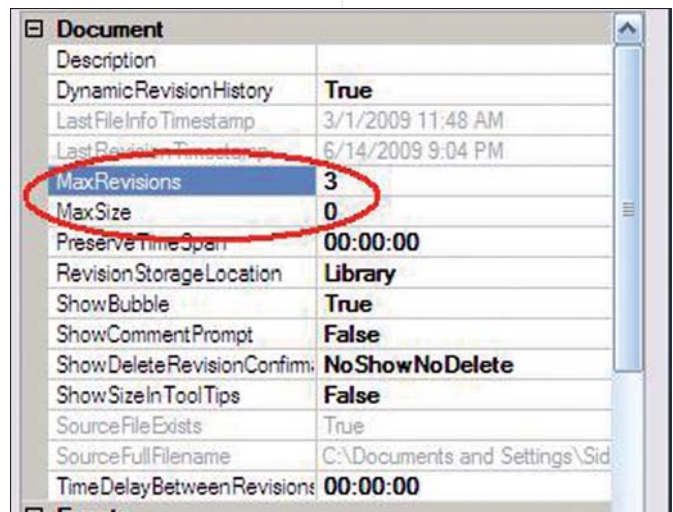
Right-clicking on a file or main library will bring up a number of options in the right click menu. Click on Options to set various behaviour options for that file or library. Under the core options tab enter desired value in the Max Revisions/Size table value. Entering zero (0) will disable the option. Click OK when done.

Installing Plugins

FileHamster has support for installing add-ons and plugins. There are a number of plugins available on the developer's site but only two of them are free – the MOG Plugin and the Log Window plug-in. Go to mogware.com/filehamster to download the plug-ins. Some of the plug-ins were free until recently and are quite useful but cost under a dollar. The plug-in will be downloaded as an executable so all you need to do is double click, specify path and say next.

Changing the behaviour of the popup bubble

When you edit files which are from a watched folder each time you hit save a pop up bubble will appear with options such as Comment, Protect, and



Specifying number of revisions

ignore file/file type. By default, the bubble appears for a painfully small amount of time and therefore doesn't give you enough time to click on it. To change this click on **Options > Preferences > Bubbles Button**. Here you can change certain attributes of the pop up bubble with respect to appearance interval, the time it will stay, and position where it will appear. Even the size and type of animation it uses can be changed. The default Stay Time is 2000 ms. Change it to at least 10,000 ms.

Trigger delayed revision

This option is available in the File Menu. What it does it that it will save a revised copy of any files using the delayed revision timer. To set a delayed

revision timer select a file and hit [Ctrl]+[P]. In the event options that appear you can set the time for delay. The default is set for one second. The time can be fed in the Hours:Minutes:Seconds format. Setting this time will specify the minimum delay time before a new revision is created. Usually the revision is created upon saving a file.

Protecting files

Files that are backed up can be protected using FileHamster. Even a particular revision that you feel is important can be protected from being deleted or overwritten. If protect is chosen on a revision it will protect only that revision from being deleted or expiring. If protect is chosen on a file, folder or library in the watch tree it will protect all revisions contained in it at that moment. To activate protect on a file right click on it and select 'Protect'. Alternatively, you can even hit [Ctrl] + [T]. This will overlay a lock icon on the file.

Benubird PDF

Benubird is a document management program that helps users store and manage all sorts of documents in an effective manner from a centralised interface. The application allows you to slice and dice documents using several options such as



Creating a new watch